

ANNA NAGAR

Purasawalkam » Villivakkam » Kolathur » Nazarathpettai » Pattabiram » Maduravoyal » Koyambedu » Tiruverkadu » Puzhal » Kilpauk » Perambur » Mogappair
Avadi » Ayyapakkam » Tiruninravur » Nerkundram » Moolakadai » Ayanavaram » Retteri » Padi » Ambattur » Tirumullaivoyal » Aminjikarai » Vysarpadi » Red Hills



ZIPKEE'la COMPARE PANNAMA..

KANNA MOODITTU
ANNA NAGAR'la FOOD ORDER PANNADHEENGA!



SAME
RESTAURANT.

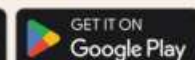


SAME
FOOD.



SAME
MENU PRICE.

SCAN. ORDER.
PAY FAIR.



Delay in completion of sewage pipe work irks Britannia Nagar residents

Work to resume after monsoon, says CMWSSB official

L. KANTHIMATHI

Britannia Nagar Residents Welfare Association in Surapet wants Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply & Sewerage Board to complete its pipe-laying work in Britannia Nagar at the earliest.

"The colony has 13 roads and sewage pipes were laid on three roads around six years ago. After that the sewage pipe work began this January. A good part of the work is over. Only a small section, around 100 metres long, is left. We noticed there was no sign of work since August. Therefore, the association has been requesting CMWSSB to complete the work for the past two months but our efforts were to no avail," says C. Sridhar, the association's president.

Following complaints by the as-



sociation a patchwork was carried out last week.

"As the dug-up roads have not been restored, the streets were muddy and the recent rains have turned them slushy. There have been instances where the wheels of vehicles have got stuck. Recently, a senior ci-

tizen's motorcycle slipped while on the move. Thankfully, he did not fall. The condition of the roads was causing considerable inconvenience. During night, this was quite dangerous. However, a patchwork has been carried out last week as a quick fix. But it is likely to get eroded in case of

heavy rains and the potholes will re-surface. Metrowater has to complete its work and after that GCC has to restore the road. Unless the work is carried out in a war footing, this north-east monsoon is going to be trying for us," adds Sridhar.

A CMWSSB official says, "The

road cut ban is in effect since September 15. The work will resume after north-east monsoon. It will take 10 days to complete the pending work." Britannia Nagar falls under Wards 31 and 32 in Zone 3 - Madhavaram of the Greater Chennai Corporation.



Third Street in Britannia Nagar on September 26, 2026 following the patchwork that was carried out on September 24, 2026; and (right) the same street a week ago. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

READERS WRITE

'Residents clean a vacant plot'



NASSER NISSAR MOHAMMED

This letter is in continuation of the one that was published on September 13, 2026 titled "Vacant plots pose a threat" in Anna Nagar edition of *The Hindu Downtown*.

Three residents came together and cleaned a vacant plot on Second Main Road in Francis Colony in Madhavaram two weeks ago when they spotted a snake that crawled near a child. They made immediate arrangements to have the plot cleaned.

During the cleaning exercise, two more adult snakes and several baby snakes were found from the unkempt plots. Besides, during the cleaning exercise, snakes started entering the nearby buildings. Those snakes were killed.

Ideally, Greater Chennai Corporation should have ensured that the owners of plots kept their property clean.

Nasser Nissar Mohammed is a resident of Madhavaram



During the cleaning exercise. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



'Footpath in Padi usurped'



T. GUNASEELAN

The footpath on CTH Road (near TVS Lucas) in Padi junction is unfriendly to pedestrians. Sacks of silt following a recently stormwater drain cleaning has been dumped on the footpaths. This is the case in most of the roads. The sacks are not cleared immediately.

T. Gunaseelan is a resident of Ambattur

ANNA NAGAR

Purasawalkam » Villivakkam » Kolathur » Nazarathpettai » Pattabiram » Maduravoyal » Koyambedu » Tiruverkadu » Puzhal » Kilpauk » Perambur » Mogappair

Avadi » Ayyappakkam » Tiruninravur » Nerkundram » Moolakadai » Ayanavaram » Retteri » Padi » Ambattur » Tirumullaivoyal » Aminjikarai » Vysarpadi » Red Hills

‘Pedestrian rights violated on Bazaar Road’

S. SWAMINTHAN

As the name suggests, Bazaar Road at Collector Nagar in Mogappair East is a commercial hub, and it obviously registers good footfall with many shoppers heading to the commercial establishments on foot. But these pedestrians have to do without pavements, which have been usurped by these shops through “extensions”. Roadside vending and unauthorised parking also eat into the pavements. Haphazard parking takes a bite out of the carriageway.

This road boasts a hospital and Seethakathi Salai, a Tamil Nadu Fire & Rescue Services station; swift movement of ambulances and fire engines will be hampered due to haphazard parking.

A bus route road, Bazaar Road connects Ambattur-Thirumangalam Main Road with Poonamallee High Road. J.J. Nagar East bus terminus on Pari Road being nearby, Bazaar Road witnesses a steady



Footpath on Bazaar Road in Mogappair.



stream of MTC buses.

The shop ‘extensions’ have covered the manholes of the stormwater drain; workers cleaning SWDs can easily miss these manholes.

Despite the presence of V3 J.J. Nagar Police Station on nearby Valayapathi Salai and its booth near the intersection of Ambattur-Thirumangalam Main Road and Bazaar Road, the encroachment of pavements has not been checked.

In a judgment on June 19, 2026, the Supreme Court declared that to walk on demarcated and well-maintained footpaths is a fundamental right. Greater Chennai Corporation has not honoured this order.

S. Swaminthan, president, JAMBA United Welfare Association

75,000 trees and a green movement

To commemorate 75 years of Chinmaya Mission, its school at Taylor’s Road has launched an ambitious tree planting drive

BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

Staff and students of Chinmaya Vidyalaya at Taylor’s Road in Kilpauk have begun to put their green thumbs to work. Recently, the school launched “Chinmaya Amritavanam”, an ambitious initiative to plant and nurture 75,000 trees to commemorate 75 years of the Chinmaya Mission, during the school’s 59th Annual Day celebrations. This would mean every activity around planting and nurturing these saplings will involve students across classes.

Built around the theme “75 Years, 75,000 Trees, One Living Legacy,” the initiative envisages planting 1,000 trees for every year of Chinmaya Mission’s journey, creating a lasting green lega-



Dignitaries at the launch of Chinmaya Amritavanam.

cy while engaging students and the wider community in environmental stewardship, says a press note.

The school has chalked out a plan to fulfil this mission of in-

creasing the green cover in and around the city.

Geetha Ganesh, principal, Chinmaya Vidyalaya, says the school will be responsible for taking care of the plants for the next

five years, and they are implementing the project in a phased manner involving other institutions as well.

“There are eight other sister schools of Chinmaya Vidyalaya in the city who will also be part of this initiative, they will be taking saplings and growing them on their campus. Likewise, our neighbouring schools Bhavan’s Rajaji Vidyashram and Maharishi Vidya Mandir in Chetpet have also agreed to be part of the green drive,” says Geetha.

The plants are geo-tagged, which means the GPS coordinates and species details will be available. Among activities that the school is planning include a visit to Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited where students would initiate the drive.

The event

■ Chinmaya Amritavanam was formally inaugurated by V. Karunapriya, Additional Principal Chief Conservator of Forests and Managing Director, TAFCON.

■ Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited (CPCL) will receive 5,000 saplings for Green Belt Development at Amallavoyal, Manali. Sri Sriram Vishwanathan, Chief General Manager (HSE), CPCL, received a sapling on behalf of CPCL, marking the first major commitment towards the 75,000-tree goal.

■ The National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) is also partnering with Chinmaya Vidyalaya in taking the initiative forward.

■ B. Chandra Mohan, IAS; Leena Nair, IAS (Retd.), Chairperson, Chinmaya Vidyalayas, Chennai; O. V. Nambiar, Zonal Director, Chinmaya Vidyalayas, Chennai; Sri Jaishankar Unnithan, Honorary Correspondent; were among the special guests at the event.



Old Markets, New Trends is a column that features markets that have continued to retain their hold on people's mindscape despite the shifting sands of fads. Through entities that have been around for a long time, it seeks to find out what makes these markets tick

Tarpaulin is just the 'trailer'

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Umbrellas are a victim of "folk association". They are certainly not the sole preserve of the monsoon with its drippy skies, but that is the period they get busier and therefore, get almost entirely associated with the rains. The tarpaulin shops at Nehru Market on Sydenhams Road in Periamet are busy through the year and get a tad busier when the monsoon is round the corner.

But one peek into these tarpaulin shops and there is not a shred of doubt about their all-year relevance. And now, tarpaulin seems like a generic term for a whole range of products that offer a protective cover to valuables. These shops sell those green shade nets for gardens, tents for camping, cotton canvas covers, car covers and bags (which are also covers, glorified covers). These bags are not high-fashion, but made of heavy-duty material and designed to last.

Tarpaulins of various thickness and materials, both determining their prices, are a dominant presence, but one can always shop for more than tarpaulins.

At Nehru Market, there is more to the tarpaulin shops than their name suggests. Their range includes camp tents for the outdoor-oriented and shade nets for those with a green thumb. With the NE monsoon (when they are a tad busier) just weeks away, a look at what helps them cope with changing buyer behaviour



Tarpaulin shops at Nehru Market. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Nehru Market is next door to Anna Market, which is dominated by sale of metal items, many of them massive spare parts that go into the running of industrial machinery. The first few shops at Nehru Market are tarpaulin shops, wholesale and retail, but step in-

side and the shops selling spare parts for industrial machinery predominate. These two markets are not next door neighbours but closer than that, as united as two intercommunicating rooms with a common door. The tarpaulin shops and those selling used spare parts for

industrial machinery exist side by side, by design.

Anil Kumar of Prakash Trading Company points out that these tarpaulin covers are used to cover machinery, among other things. While out here to purchase metal parts for heavy-duty industrial machinery, someone might pick up tarpaulins too. These shops also draw adventurers who like to camp out in a temporary shelter under the skies. Similarly, those with a green thumb. The green shade nets are for them.

Anil Kumar notes that almost every shop, the wholesale shops for certain, would have a tailor attached to it. The tents, shade nets and cotton canvas have to be made to order, often. Promptness is a key factor driving success and survival in this business.

Many of these tarpaulin shops are carryovers from a different era, one pithily defined as "Moore Market". Following the Moore Market fire in the 1980s, traders fanned out depending on where they were allocated a space. That is how some

of the tarpaulin sellers ended up in Nehru Market, managed by Greater Chennai Corporation.

Anil Kumar shoulders the weight of a legacy: the shop was established by his father Narayan Jha over 50 years ago. He worked alongside his father and brother before their deaths, and now the weight of that legacy is entirely on his shoulders. And he finds it to be excruciatingly heavy not only due to the lack of support from a kindred soul, but also market realities. "Counter sales has dwindled," says Anil. "Demand has generally fallen with online shopping changing the way customers buy."

So this is where it stands: much of the regular business comes from factories that use the material to cover machinery, as well as from transporters. Anil qualifies that, saying there is still demand for shade nets, tents, car covers and other items but there is huge competition from various quarters.

The promise of getting items at wholesale rates or even purse-friendly retail rates continues to hold out an attraction for the cost-conscious, and they hit Nehru market. Another shop seller, who does not want to be named, points out that tarpaulins, camping tents and car covers are available at wholesale prices on a section of Walltax Road, largely Ramanan Road and near Elephant Gate Street. But Nehru Market in Sydenhams Road scores on ease of access.

LIFFY THOMAS

More than 11,500 kilos of abandoned, lost or discarded fishing nets, known as ghost nets, were collected in the last three months from the Chennai coast, largely from the Neelankarai-to-Kovalam section. That is just the tip of the iceberg. Tonnes of them are yet to be retrieved from our long coastline, many entangled around marine animals preventing them from moving freely.

“In fact, when the North East Monsoon sets in, the quantity of ghost nets being collected also increases depending on the wind pattern seen during the months of October to March. From December onwards, the ghost nets are observed floating closer to the shore,” says Supraja Dharani, founder of TREE Foundation, a Chennai-based non-governmental organisation that focuses on marine conservation.

Since 2021, the Foundation has been playing a key role in removing tonnes of ghost nets by empowering different stakeholders attached to the seas, the local community and the fishers being their chief ambassadors.

As part of capacity building programmes, they conduct workshops to train fishers in identifying and retrieving a net by steering their boats towards it, looking for marine species in the net, releasing it and pulling the net closer to the boat and bringing it to the shores where it is weighed and sent for recycling.

Tree Foundation currently works in the Chennai-Chengalpattu stretch of the coast, many parts of Andhra Pradesh starting from Sullurpetta, Bapatla, Prakasham, Godavari, Vizianagaram and Srikakulam, southern Odisha and western Goa.

Sea Turtle Protection Force

“Our work in retrieving ghost nets extends to more than 800 km, 285 fishing villages, and 411 fishing



Fishing for ghost nets

Through its Sea Turtle Protection Force, TREE Foundation has built an army of fishers who retrieve ghost nets from the sea



An awareness programme by TREE Foundation for fishermen about ghost nets; and (above) fishermen retrieve abandoned nets.

community members who are part of the Sea Turtle Protection Force; they are the point of contact for fishers of the respective villages,”

says Supraja.

One of the biggest motivations for fishers to retrieve ghost nets is the incentive they receive for the

quantity they collect.

The amount of payment depends on the weight of the net. “Fifty percent of the amount goes to their bank account and the rest to the wife’s or mother’s account, which is used for children’s education, repair of nets and medical emergencies,” says the marine activist.

In the last five years, 217 tonnes of ghost nets have been handed to the TREE Foundation. To further felicitate those who have removed the maximum quantity of ghost nets, a felicitation event is held, usually in the first week of October, where other stakeholders including officers from the Coast Guard and Fisheries department are invited.

“Our success is the result of awareness programmes that we conduct teaching the fisherman how to release entangled endangered marine life including turtles, retrieve the ghost net and hand it over to TREE Foundation. Till date 974 marine megafauna have been released by the fishermen all recorded by videos or photos,” she

says.

The abandoned nets are weighed and sent for recycling. The Foundation has made a pathway at its biodiversity centre in Marakkanam.

Finding corporates willing to support the programme financially is a challenge, and Supraja says they are grateful to be supported by Royal Enfield and AstraZeneca in the ghost net retrieval and incentivisation programme for fishermen along Chengalpattu and Chennai coast.

The weight of these nets range from 100 to 700 kilos and tying it to their boats and bringing it to the shore is not easy.

“We want more corporates to support us in other coastal areas as well. We are soon going to set up a small unit where the nets will be shredded and made into small tiles,” she says. More support from corporates would mean getting more fishermen to join the diving team.

Removing ghost nets entangled in coral reefs will also be an extension of Foundation’s work.

Extending from coast to coast

BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

If you are a certified diver then HCL Foundation, the CSR arm of HCL Technologies, should be happy to engage your service to scour the ocean depths for ghost nets. Under HCL Harit, the Foundation has been playing a key role in removing ghost nets.

Started in 2022 from the Chennai coast in Neelankarai, today the initiative extends along the Gulf of Mannar, coasts along Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh and Odisha.

As per data, they have successfully mapped, retrieved, and repurposed nearly 4 lakh plus kilograms of abandoned, lost or discarded fishing gear (ALDFG), across several distinct coastal locations in India.

In the Gulf of Mannar, more than 12.9 metric tons of ghost nets have been removed from ecologically sensitive habitats surrounding 21 islands. In Kundapura, Karnataka, they have launched an innovative buy-back model that incentivises fishers to return dis-

carded nets, helping recover over 10,000 kg of ghost gear.

Nidhi Pundhir, vice-president - Global CSR, HCL Tech and Director, HCL Foundation, says they have a MoU with the Ministry of Environment, and over the years they have built a nationwide coalition involving scientific institutions, diving teams, fisher communities, the Indian Coast Guard, coastal police, and grassroot organisations to tackle marine debris.

A dedicated ghost gear man-

agement component was integrated into the Fisher Friend Mobile Application, enabling real time tracking and reporting of ghost gear by fishing communities.

Nidhi says there is a whole process involved in recycling the ghost nets that serves as a supplementary income for communities. “When we get these nets, they have a whole lot of salt coating on it and is not easily recyclable. We are doing a lot of R&D including converting them into nets which are used for various sports activities, designing bags and for other creative use,” says Nidhi.

To engage university students

to design upcycled, functional products from the retrieved nylons, the Foundation conducted the Ghost Net Innovation Challenge. Recently, on International Coastal Cleanup Day, the Foundation organised a mega cleanup campaign of oceans, involving volunteer and community members.

“From CSR design point of view, we have been thinking that we really need to take a district-level kind of an approach in certain places where we have higher employee strength. And we have been looking at a “convergence model” as our next step,” says Nidhi.

At Mudichur, birders chanced upon a Java sparrow while having gone there in the hope of seeing another bird species. The Java sparrow is a breeding resident in parts of Indonesia. And this particular individual is likely a captive bird that had slipped out of a cage, raising questions about the sordid side of the pet trade

PRINCE FREDERICK

The backdrop can sometimes cast a sombre shadow over a stage pulsating with a grand achievement. Knowing the backstory can automatically signal restraint, cutting out celebration, even justified celebration, without a twinge of regret. An extensively reported event this year would make this idea clearer. Royal Challengers Bangalore cut out the victory parade following their triumph in IPL 2026 clearly because the “backdrop” of a tragic stampede the previous year loomed large casting a long shadow over a merry moment that played out on a grand stage. Something parallel to that, sans the sombreness, happened recently in the Chennai Metropolitan Area.

Over a week’s duration, the start date being September 19, Mudichur in Tambaram witnessed a parade of birders out to catch a glimpse of a rare avian, so rare that when news of its sighting hit their “auriculars”, some dropped their telephoto zoom lens. It was a Java sparrow (*Padda oryzivora*) found in parts of Indonesia, Java being one of them, where they are meant to be found. The sad story (actually, the backstory birders out here were aware of) is that this bird is also found where it has no business poking its beak around, and it is not to be blamed for that. Aviculture and, in a larger sense, human beings’ innate ability honed by greed to interfere with Nature’s delicate but sound systems. The birders sensed this bird could have slipped past the open shutter of some cage

here, and that knowledge tempered the sense of having found something rare. They clicked away still, but there was restraint in their posts about the sighting.

Birders Jithesh Babu and Saravanan Manian had discovered the Java sparrow in Mudichur serendipitously while seeking to pay another bird a visit, a passage migrant in Chennai.

“On September 19, we were there looking for the European roller, which was reported to have been sighted at Mudichur,” says Jithesh. The European roller (*Coracias garulus*) not showing up immediately, the birders ventured a little further in than they had expected to, and

there it was, a surprise in a package of red, pink, grey, black and white: a Java sparrow with, probably until recently, a local address on its calling card.

If the European roller had a sense of humour and the power of speech to express it, it surely would have rasped out “and you thought I was the surprise!” The European roller breeds in Europe and winters in Africa and is known to ink in Chennai as a pit stop on its iconic long-distance migration, almost treated as a sub category in migration, being dubbed “roller migration”. Last year, European roller sighting was reported from the Broken Bridge area of the Adyar Estuary.

Java sparrow and (above) European roller at Mudichur on September 19.
PHOTOS: JITHESH BABU



VELS University honours 1,000 school teachers



VELS University organised the VELS Teachers Excellence Awards 2026 across its various campuses. As part of the Teachers' Day celebrations, the felicitation ceremony was held at the VELS University campus in Pallavaram. Premalatha Vijayakant, MLA, Virudhachalam Constituency and general secretary, DMDK, graced the occasion as chief guest and felicitated the teachers, says a press release.

Preethaa Ganesh, vice president, VELS University, said that "teaching is the finest profession, as it creates and shapes all other professions."

Premalatha Vijayakant recalled the teacher who had a significant influence on her during her school years. She said: "Teachers carry the great responsibility of guiding students on the right path. Captain Vijayakant deeply understood the im-



▼ Premalatha Vijayakant with the awardees

portance of education and extended educational assistance to thousands of students to help them continue their studies. Behind the success of every student, there is the contribution of a teacher who guided and encouraged them. There was such a teacher in my

own life as well. A teacher named Loganathan guided me and played an important role in shaping me into the person I am today. Though he is no longer with us, I will always remember and acknowledge his contribution to all my achievements."

The VELS Teachers Excellence Awards 2026 have been instituted to recognise and honour the dedicated service of teachers who play a significant role in shaping students' knowledge, skills, character and future, says the press release.

The event was attended by Arthi Ganesh, pro chancellor, VELS University; M. Baskaran, vice chancellor; M. Chandrasekaran, registrar, and other senior members of the university administration.

135 school teachers in the limelight at Guru Dhakshina 2026

Agurchand Manmull Jain College, recently hosted its much-anticipated annual ceremony, Guru Dhakshina 2026, a celebration of gratitude recognising teachers at the Bhagwan Mahaveer Gyan Bhavan.

The college paid tribute to 135 school teachers, chosen from across schools in and around Chennai, says a press release.

The ceremony was graced by an eminent panel of guests and dignitaries. Film actor, motivational speaker and educa-

tionist Dhamu was chief guest. Founder of Farmguru Agritech was the guest of honour.

The event was also attended by Udhan Kumar Chordia, secretary; Hemant P. Chordia, associate secretary; N. Venkataramanan, director; M.M. Ramya, dean; and R. Surekha, deputy dean.

The ceremony featured a symbolic gesture of a student seeking blessings from a teacher, capturing the Guru-Shishya tradition.



Villivakkam school student wins bronze



Boxer Lakshan S., a class XI student of Shri Krishnaswamy Matriculation Higher Secondary School in Villivakkam won a State bronze in the under-17 category at Namakkal. According to a press release, he has won many medals at district, State and zonal levels since 2023. He also earned gold and silver medals at a national level event in Maharashtra, adds the release.

City ophthalmologist honoured at conference in Bangkok

Ophthalmologist from Chennai Dr D P Prakash was invited to give a keynote speech on eye care at the United Nations Conference Centre in Bangkok on September 25. The summit was on sustainable living and wellbeing, says a press release.

His presentation was titled "The World- First Artificial Intelligence Based Vision Care System."

In his address, the chief eye surgeon of American Eye Care Centre highlighted how India is losing a gross national income of 646 billion rupees due to the 70 million vision-impaired population apart from the 4.9 million blind people, says a press release.

He spoke a proprietary Agentic AI Technology known as "The Serranova" which would integrate every aspect of the vision testing process right from history to diagnosis and eye wear selection and referral, adds the press release.

The AI also generates what he calls "The Prakash Perfect Vision Score" that enables the patient to understand if his eyes are normal or not, says the press release.



Delegates from various member countries and dignitaries from WHO, Red Cross International and ambassadors to Thailand from Morocco, Nepal South Africa, Russia, and Hungary took part.

On the occasion, he received the Global Change Maker Award for his contribution towards advancing eye care and sustainable health care development from Dr . Giovanni Jing, UNESCO, Italy.

Best Bargains

BUYING
WORKING AND NOT WORKING, A/C, BRASS, STAINLESS STEEL, FRIDGE, OLD COMPUTER, LAPTOP, UPS, BATTERIES, MUSIC SYSTEM, WATER HEATER, GYM ITEMS, WOODEN FURNITURE, SOFAS, COT, BEURO, DINNING SET
ALL A TO Z SCRAPS
VANITHA TRADERS
96001 01534
No Visiting Charges

SOFA SERVICE
WE UNDERTAKE:
1 Any Sofa's
2 Any Recliner Sofa's
3 Any Cushions
4 Reupholstery
5 Re-conditioning
at VERY MODERATE CHARGES
K.N.S. RAJAN SERVICES
76671 33233
93818 03956

To advertise in
DOWNTOWN
Contact:
SATHIYAMORTHY
70927 03458

FSSAI Certified
AMUTHALAKSHMI KITCHEN
HOME FOOD
MADE WITH LOVE, SERVED WITH CARE
AUTHENTIC SOUTH INDIAN CUISINE
100% PURE VEG
8754590060 / 9500031050

A photo contest for the deaf

The last date for submission of entries is September 30. The theme of the contest is nature conservation and the winners will be honoured during Wildlife Week 2026 in October

Rotary club of Chennai Crown and Madras photobloggers are organising an exclusive photo contest for the deaf on nature conservation, as part of International Week of Deaf Awareness. The link for submission is <http://tinyurl.com/YAAVARUM-PHOTOCONTEST>. The last date for submission is September.

Winners of the contest will be honoured during Wildlife Week 2026 in October.

Earlier, on September 20, also as part of the International Week of Deaf Awareness, a nature photo walk was organised at Nan-mangalam reserve forest exclusively for the deaf community, with interpreter support, through a collaborative effort of Care Earth Trust, Tamil Nadu Forest Department, Madras Photobloggers, and Rotary Club of Chennai Crown.

Thirty-five deaf participants actively took part in the photo-walk. Officials from Care Earth



Trust and the Tamil Nadu Forest Department introduced participants to the rich diversity of flora and fauna, helping them observe and appreciate the natural environment around them.

Rotary club of Chennai Crown and Madras photobloggers helped the participants in documenting nature, says a press release

Participants captured their ex-

periences through mobile phones and cameras, exploring nature through their own perspectives and creativity. The programme provided an inclusive space for the deaf community to connect with nature, learn about biodiversity, and express themselves through photography and the upcoming photocontest exclusively for the deaf.



Season two of Battle of Brains

Battle of Brains, an inter-school quiz, is back with its second season. Organised by Casagrand, in association with Nexus Consulting, schools across Chennai can register teams of two students from classes 6 to 10 at no cost. Registrations are open until October 5, 2026.

The event will be held from October 10 to November 15, 2026.

The winning teams from the zonal rounds will advance to the city final, where they will compete for the Battle of Brains Season 2 title.

The second season will also extend the quizzing experience beyond students with a dedicated parents and teachers quiz.

The first season saw enthusiastic participation from over 250 schools across Chennai. Sachin Sathyasivan and Perri Karthik Chidambaram from B. V. Bhavan's Rajaji Vidhyashram School were crowned the champions of Casagrand's Battle of Brains 2025, winning exciting prizes worth ₹4 lakh along with the prestigious trophy, said a release.

Inter-school oratorical competition

Union Christian Matriculation Higher Secondary School, Chetpet will be conducting the second edition of its inter-school oratorical competition, Oratoria'26, for students of classes VII to XII on October 29 and 30. The event would also feature a debate segment with an overall prize pack-

age worth ₹90,000 including a return ticket to an exotic destination, said a release.



Scan the QR code to register.
Contact: 73051 75551/97892 91683

Two-day meet on digital Innovation



A two-day conference on "Digital Innovation, Global Integrity and Transformative Education" was held at Shri Krishnaswamy College for Women.

On the occasion, S. Sudalai Muthu, Dean and Professor of Banking Technology, College Development Council, Pondicherry

University, delivered the presidential address, says a press release.

In his address, he highlighted the digital innovations in commerce and business and also drew attention to ethics and sustainability.

The event witnessed presentation of 116 papers, adds the press release.

Reflexology services

Happy Foot offers reflexology services. According to a press release, the services are aimed at relaxation and improving circulation. The outlet is at No:1, 48A, Pulla Avenue, Shenoy Nagar.



COMMERCIAL SPACE FOR RENT

350 sqft Commercial space
for Rent @ 3rd Street,
Rajiv Gandhi Nagar,
Pudur, Ambattur

Suitable for

- Small office
- Clinic
- Diagnostic Centre
- Tuition
- Service centre
- Parlour etc.

99419 66966

பாஸ்போர்ட் சர்வீசஸ்

Vaigai Wings
The Dependable Travel Service

Crescent Court, 963 Periyar EVR High Road,
Chennai - 600 084, India

Tel: +91 7338791804 | +91 6384552233 | +91-44-26413126

Email: welcome@vaigai.com | Website: <https://www.vaigai.com>

PASSPORT SERVICES

38 YEARS
1988-2022